

UNISON 'There for you'

NEWSLETTER

We are UNISON's registered charity offering FREE and confidential services, benefits and support including:-

- Financial Assistance - if you are in financial hardship due to unforeseen circumstances
- Links to Credit Unions - for loans/savings
- Small Grants - School Uniform May-July & Winter Fuel Dec-Feb
- Debt advice - freephone 0800 389 3302
- Wellbeing breaks - during illness/respite for carers
- Support & information

To access support:

- contact your local branch welfare officer. If you do not know who this is please contact :
- UNISON Direct on 0800 0857 857 or
- There for You 0207 121 5620; thereforyou@unison.co.uk;
- For work issues contact UNISON Direct 0800 0857 857
- To join UNISON please contact 0800 171 2193

CHARITY CHALLENGE 2017



**DO SOMETHING EPIC
IN 2017**

**Join us for the
Pyrenean Challenge in Catalonia, Spain
15 – 19 May 2017**

CHARITY CHALLENGE 2017

WALK ALONG THE COASTLINE TO THE MOUNTAINS;
TAKE IN THE STUNNING SCENERY, CUTTING THROUGH OLIVE
GROVES AND HILLSIDES, PAST SECLUDED COVES AND BEACHES
WHILST CHALLENGING YOURSELF TO RAISE MONEY FOR THE
CHARITY THAT'S EXCLUSIVELY FOR UNISON MEMBERS –
THERE FOR YOU

You'll have great fun, get fit, make new friends and stay in some
fantastic places in what is considered to be one of the most striking
regions of Spain, known as Catalonia.

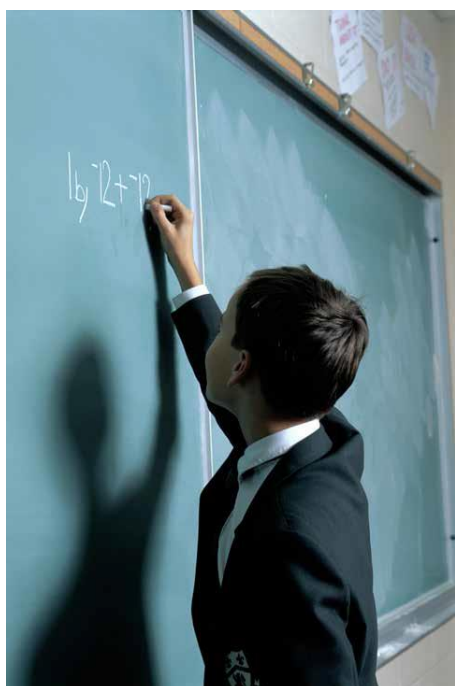
*"I really don't know what I would have done without your help. It is really appreciated and
I thank you from the bottom of my heart. P.S. I am so proud to be a member of UNISON".*
UNISON Member

For more information contact
0207 121 5620 or e mail: thereforyou@unison.co.uk

SCHOOL UNIFORM GRANTS

What are UNISON There for You School Uniform Grants?

In addition to our normal range of services and in response to the growing
difficulties many members on low income face, a
programme has been put in place that will assist
our most vulnerable members with the cost of
purchasing school uniforms.



How much are the Grants?

They are one-off grants of £40.00 per school age
child, up to a total of £120.00

For an application form contact

- your local UNISON branch or
- UNISON Direct 0800 0857 857 or
- go to website -
unison.org.uk/thereforyou

SCHOOL UNIFORM GRANTS

School Uniform Grant eligibility – (full details in the application pack)

- Have a total net annual household income of £18,000 or less.
- Members and their partners must not have combined savings or, a rolling bank balance of more than £800.00
- You must not have received financial assistance from UNISON There for You during the previous six months
- A member must have paid 4 weeks subscriptions before the launch date of this programme (16/5/16)
- Applications are limited to one per household
- Ensure you send all requested paperwork with the form or the application cannot be accepted

Information going out to all branches imminently
(closing date 15th July 2016)

BRANCH WELFARE OFFICER TRAINING

BWO INDUCTION COURSES	
National course – Bristol Venue – tba - 19/20 July	Please apply Andrea Barker a.barker@unison.co.uk 0207 121 5620
Regional course – West Midlands Venue - Birmingham – 15/16 Nov	Please apply Aimee Rawlins A.Rawlins@unison.co.uk 0121 685 3143
FURTHER COURSES	
Supporting members with Debt & Budgeting Venue – Birmingham - 8th June	FULL
Making the Case Venue - Leeds - 15th Sept	Please apply Andrea Barker a.barker@unison.co.uk 0207 121 5620
Supporting members with Debt & Budgeting Venue – Glasgow - 21st Sept	Please apply Andrea Barker a.barker@unison.co.uk 0207 121 5620

For more information or if you have any training query please contact Andrea Barker
a.barker@unison.co.uk 0207 121 5620



Octopus monthly prize draw
for just £1 per month
you could win **£1,000 !!**

To join contact thereforyou@unison.co.uk
or call: 0207 121 5620

‘There for You’ SEMINAR

When – 1-3 September 2016
Where – Croyde Bay

Look for further announcements and more
details over the next few months

Croyde Bay
HOLIDAY RESORT NORTH DEVON

This is your 'at a glance' guide to 'The Benefit System'

kindly produced by the Social Welfare Training Limited 2014 Jan
www.socialwelfaretraining.co.uk;

Stage 1 Benefits	Stage 2 Benefits	Stage 3 Benefits
- Non means tested - These are earnings replacement benefits	- Non means tested - Universal benefits	- Means tested - These are means tested benefits
JSA - Job Seekers Allowance (contribution based)	DLA – Disability Living Allowance	Child Benefit
ESA – Employment & Support Allowance (contributory)	Attendance Allowance	State Pension Credit
Incapacity Benefit	PIP – Personal Independence Payment	Income support
Severe Disablement Allowance	Guardian's Allowance	JSA – Job Seekers Allowance – income based
State Retirement Pension	Industrial Injuries Benefit	ESA – Employment & Support Allowance – income related
Maternity Allowance	Armed Forces Compensation Scheme/War Pensions	Working & Child Tax Credits
Widows or Bereavement Pension	Winter Fuel Payments	Housing Benefit
Widowed Mother's or Widowed Parent's Allowance		Local Council Tax Support
Carers Allowance		Reg. Social Fund
		UC – Universal Credit

Universal Credit is a new benefit that you can only get in some parts of the UK. If you're living in a Universal Credit area, you might need to apply for Universal Credit instead of other existing benefits like Jobseeker's Allowance, Housing Benefit or Tax Credits etc. If you're not sure whether or not you can apply, contact the Universal Credit helpline or visit your local Citizens Advice Bureau.

Universal Credit helpline

Tel: 0345 600 0723; Textphone: 0345 600 0743
Monday to Friday, 8am to 6pm

Tax Credits & Universal Credit -

Universal Credit usually pays less than Tax Credits. About a million people who are entitled to Tax Credits aren't claiming. That's why **UNISON** has teamed up with **entitledto Ltd** to deliver the **UNISON Tax Credit (Take Up) Calculator** to help people claim Tax Credits before Universal Credit arrives locally. On 11 April 2016 the help people get with Universal Credit is being cut. 80,000 people in work will be hit immediately. Single parents, for example, lose over £50/week. The roll-out of the new Universal Credit software starts in May and

will be completed by 2018. Once it arrives locally you won't be able to apply for Tax Credits. Universal Credit usually pays less than Tax Credits. The government says no-one who moves from Tax Credits to Universal Credit will be worse off. That means if you sign up for Tax Credits before the change, the amount of money you get will stay protected when you move over to UC, so long as your circumstances don't change. This could be worth as much as an extra £50 a week for some people and over 5 years as much as £14,000.

Make sure you don't lose out with the UNISON Tax Credit (Take Up) Calculator

It takes just 2 minutes using our tool to see how much you could receive in Tax Credits

[Use the UNISON Tax Credit \(Take Up\) calculator](#)

<https://unison-takeup.entitledto.co.uk/Home/NewClaim>



For further UNISON Welfare information please contact 020 7121 5620
thereforyou@unison.co.uk

UNISON Welfare, UNISON Centre, 130 Euston Road, London NW1 2AY Registered charity 1023552/Sc0 38305